

—and the ability to communicate it all fluidly seems to support the hypothesis that Satoshi is more than one person. But who would they be? While the mystery may never be solved, Satoshi most certainly was aware of Wall Street’s growing instability.

THE FINANCIAL CRISIS OF 2008

For financial titans, 2008 proved a slowly unfolding nightmare. In March of that year, the first major Wall Street institution—Bear Stearns—acquiesced to its demons. After weathering every type of market for 85 years, Bear Stearns was finally dragged under by a slumping housing market. On March 16, JPMorgan Chase & Co. bought it for \$2 a share, about 1 percent of the value of its \$170 per share price from a year prior.⁹ To catalyze the deal, the Federal Reserve agreed to facilitate the purchase of \$29 billion in distressed assets from Bear Stearns.¹⁰ Yet disturbingly, a month after the buyout, John Mack and Lloyd Blankfein, CEOs of Morgan Stanley and Goldman Sachs Group Inc., respectively, told shareholders the housing market crisis was going to be short-lived and nearing a close.¹¹

Much of this crisis was born of irresponsible lending, known as *subprime loans*, to Americans who couldn’t repay their debts. Historically, when a bank issued a loan, the bank was on the hook for ensuring that the borrower repaid the funds. However, in the case of many subprime loans, once these loans were issued to borrowers, they were then